Mr. Wei's Chinese Class

Phase 1 & Phase 2: Absolute Beginner Guide for Khaopan

Welcome to Chinese, Khaopan! I am Mr. Wei. This workbook contains your complete Phase 1 (Pronunciation Engine) and Phase 2 (Core Sentence Structure) training. Let's start compiling your new language.

Phase 1: The Pronunciation Engine (Pinyin & Tones)

Lesson 1: Pinyin and The Four Tones

Chinese uses characters, but we read them using a romanized alphabet called **Pinyin**. Every syllable has an **initial** (starting consonant), a **final** (vowel), and a **tone**.

Tones are crucial. The same sound with a different pitch means a completely different thing.

Tone	Mark	Pitch Movement	Meaning Example (ma)
1st Tone	mā	High and flat (singing a note)	妈 (Mother)
2nd Tone	má	Rising (asking "Huh?")	麻 (Hemp)
3rd Tone	mǎ	Dipping down then up	马 (Horse)
4th Tone	mà	Falling sharply (command)	骂 (Scold)

Workbook 1: Tones & Pinyin

Answer the following 8 questions.

1. What is the starting consonant of a Pinyin syllable called?
2. Which tone is high and flat? (1, 2, 3, or 4)
3. Which tone dips down and then goes up?
4. True or False: "mā" and "mà" mean the exact same thing.
5. What is the Pinyin mark for the 2nd tone on the letter 'a'?
6. If you are giving a sharp command, which tone does it sound like?
7. Identify the 'final' (vowel part) in the pinyin syllable "hao".
8. What is the Pinyin system used for?

Answers: 1. Initial | 2. 1st Tone | 3. 3rd Tone | 4. False | 5. á | 6. 4th Tone | 7. ao | 8. To read the sounds of Chinese characters.

Lesson 2: Greetings and Numbers

Let's practice reading Pinyin with some essential words you will use every day.

Chinese	Pinyin	Meaning
你好	*nǐ hǎo*	Hello
谢谢	*xiè xie*	Thank you
再见	*zài jiàn*	Goodbye
一, 二, 三	*yī, èr, sān*	1, 2, 3
四, 五, 六	*sì, wǔ, liù*	4, 5, 6
七, 八, 九, 十	*qī, bā, jiǔ, shí*	7, 8, 9, 10

Workbook 2: First Words

1. Translate to English: *nǐ hǎo*
2. Translate to English: *xiè xie*
3. How do you say "Goodbye" in Pinyin?
4. Match the number: 一 (A. 2, B. 1, C. 3)
5. Match the number: *wǔ* (A. 4, B. 5, C. 6)
6. Match the number: 十 (A. 8, B. 9, C. 10)
7. Write the Pinyin for the number 8.
8. Translate to Pinyin: 3, 2, 1.

Answers: 1. Hello | 2. Thank you | 3. zài jiàn | 4. B (1) | 5. B (5) | 6. C (10) | 7. bā | 8. sān, èr, yī.

Phase 2: Core HSK 1 Grammar (S-V-O Structure)

Lesson 3: The "To Be" Verb & Pronouns

Chinese sentence structure is exactly like English: **Subject + Verb + Object**. Verbs never change their shape (no past/future tense conjugations!).

Chinese	Pinyin	Meaning
我	*wǒ*	I / Me
你	*nǐ*	You
他 / 她	*tā / tā*	He / She (Sound exactly the same!)
是	*shì*	Am / Is / Are (To be)
学生	*xué sheng*	Student

Example: I am a student. = 我是学生。 *(wǒ shì xué sheng.)*

Workbook 3: Identity

1. What does **我** (*wǒ*) mean?
2. Translate to Chinese characters: "You"
3. True or False: "He" and "She" sound identical in spoken Chinese.
4. What is the verb for "Am/Is/Are"?
5. Translate to Pinyin: "I am a student."
6. Translate to English: **他是学生。** (*tā shì xué sheng.*)
7. Sentence Scramble: **学生** / **你** / **是** (Rearrange to "You are a student")
8. Fill in the blank: *wǒ* ___ *Khaopan.* (I am Khaopan).

Answers: 1. I / Me | 2. 你 | 3. True | 4. 是 (shì) | 5. wǒ shì xué sheng. | 6. He is a student. | 7. 你是学生。 (nǐ shì xué sheng.) | 8. shì (是)

Lesson 4: Action Verbs and Objects

Let's add some action verbs to our Subject-Verb-Object blueprint.

Action Verbs	Nouns (Objects)
吃 (*chī*) - to eat	**苹果** (*píng guǒ*) - apple
喝 (*hē*) - to drink	**水** (*shuǐ*) - water
看 (*kàn*) - to look/watch	**书** (*shū*) - book

Example: I eat an apple. = **我吃苹果。** *(wǒ chī píng guǒ.)*

Example: He drinks water. = **他喝水。** *(tā hē shuǐ.)*

Workbook 4: Actions

1. Translate to English: **我喝水。** (*wǒ hē shuǐ.*)
2. Translate to English: **你看书。** (*nǐ kàn shū.*)
3. What is the Chinese character for "eat"?
4. What is the Pinyin for "apple"?
5. Sentence Scramble: **水 / 喝 / 他** (Rearrange to "He drinks water")
6. Translate to Pinyin: "I read (look at) a book."
7. Match the noun: *shuǐ* (A. Book, B. Water, C. Apple)
8. Translate to Chinese characters: I eat an apple.

Answers: 1. I drink water. | 2. You read a book. | 3. 吃 | 4. píng guǒ | 5. 他喝水。 | 6. wǒ kàn shū. | 7. B (Water) | 8. 我吃苹果。

Lesson 5: Asking Questions (吗 & 什么)

Turning a statement into a Yes/No question in Chinese is incredibly easy. Just add the particle **吗** (***ma***) to the very end of the sentence!

Statement: You are a student. (**你是学生。**)

Question: Are you a student? (**你是学生吗？** - *nǐ shì xué sheng ma?*)

To ask "What?", use **什么** (***shén me***). It replaces the object in the sentence.

Example: What do you eat? = **你吃什么？** *(nǐ chī shén me?)*

Workbook 5: Interrogation

1. What particle do you add to the end of a sentence to make it a Yes/No question?
2. Translate to English: **你是Khaopan吗？**
3. Translate to English: **他喝水吗？** (*tā hē shuǐ ma?*)
4. What does **什么** (*shén me*) mean?
5. Translate to Chinese: "What do you drink?" (Hint: You drink what?)
6. Translate to Pinyin: **你看什么？**
7. Turn this into a question: **我吃苹果。** (Make it: Do I eat an apple?)
8. Match: "ma" is used for (A. What, B. Who, C. Yes/No).

Answers: 1. 吗 (ma) | 2. Are you Khaopan? | 3. Does he drink water? | 4. What | 5. 你喝什么？ | 6. nǐ kàn shén me? | 7. 我吃苹果吗？ | 8. C (Yes/No).

Lesson 6: Possession (The Magic "的")

To show ownership (like adding "'s" in English), Chinese uses the particle **的 (*de*)**.

- **我** (I) + **的** = **我的** (*wǒ de*) - My / Mine
- **你** (You) + **的** = **你的** (*nǐ de*) - Your / Yours

Family Nouns: **爸爸** (*bà ba*) = Dad | **妈妈** (*mā ma*) = Mom

Example: This is my dad. = **这是我的爸爸。** *(zhè shì wǒ de bà ba.)* ***这** (zhè) means "This".*

Workbook 6: Ownership

1. What particle is used to show possession?
2. Translate to English: **我的** (*wǒ de*)
3. Translate to English: **你的妈妈** (*nǐ de mā ma*)
4. Translate to Chinese characters: "My apple" (Hint: wǒ de píng guǒ)
5. Translate to Pinyin: **我的书** (My book)
6. What does **爸爸** (*bà ba*) mean?
7. Fill in the blank: **他是 ___ 爸爸。** (He is MY dad.)
8. Sentence Scramble: **妈妈 / 的 / 是 / 这 / 我** (This is my mom.)

Answers: 1. 的 (de) | 2. My / Mine | 3. Your mom | 4. 我的苹果 | 5. wǒ de shū | 6. Dad / Father | 7. 我的 (wǒ de) | 8. 这是我的妈妈。

End of Phase 1 & 2. Keep practicing your Pinyin and tones, Khaopan!